Pratik Praveen Mehta

Supply Chain Manager | Strategic Sourcing, Supplier Management, Inventory & Lifecycle Planning

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PROFILE SUMMARY

Supply chain manager with 12+ years across the automotive aftermarket, supply chain consulting, and manufacturing. Leads sourcing, supplier management, inventory, and lifecycle strategy for a private-label division with $120M in revenue and $60M+ in annual spend. Negotiates supplier contracts through signature, runs RFI/RFQ/RFP processes and total cost of ownership analysis, and manages contract manufacturers and supplier quality. Secured a 2% cost reduction on $25M in spend, freed $15M+ in working capital, and built a forecasting engine that lifted forecast accuracy from 53% to 74%. Owns the roadmap for a catalog platform serving 30,000+ customers and 120+ suppliers. Leads 4 direct and 3 indirect reports and briefs executives up to the CFO and CEO. B.E. Electrical Engineering and MBA; Lean Six Sigma Green Belt.

CORE SKILLS

Sourcing & Supplier Management: Strategic Sourcing, RFI/RFQ/RFP, Contract Negotiation, Total Cost of Ownership, Tooling & NRE, Contract Manufacturers, AVL Qualification, Corrective Action Plans, Supplier Performance, Cost Reduction

Inventory, Planning & Lifecycle: Inventory Optimization, End-of-Life & Excess Inventory, Demand Forecasting (Statistical & ML), New Product Introduction, Product Supersession, Spare Parts & Refurbishment, S&OP Support

Data, Analytics & Systems: SQL, Python, Tableau, Power BI, SAP IBP, SAP Procurement, Kinaxis, Custom ERP, Advanced Excel, AI Agent Development

Leadership & Process: Cross-Functional Leadership, Team Management, Executive Communication, Lean Six Sigma, Catalog & Product Data, Roadmap Ownership, Jira

AI AGENTS CONFIGURED AT LKQ CORPORATION

- **Competitor Price Tracking Agent:** monitors competitor and market pricing for private-label products to support pricing and sourcing decisions.
- **Marketing Asset Creation Agent:** generates marketing assets for private-label brands.
- **Forecast Accuracy & Insights Agent:** surfaces forecast accuracy results and insights for planning teams.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Business Process Specialist — Supply Chain Strategy & Operations — LKQ Corporation **May 2023 – Present**

San Jose, CA

- Lead sourcing and supplier management for a private-label division with $120M in revenue and $60M+ in annual spend, working with suppliers and contract manufacturers; run RFI/RFQ/RFP processes and TCO models and negotiate contracts through signature, including tooling and non-recurring engineering (NRE) terms.
- Secured a 2% cost reduction on $25M in spend through supplier cost-sharing and tooling and NRE negotiation.
- Freed $15M+ in working capital by redesigning end-of-life and excess & obsolete inventory strategy and governance.
- Escalation point for supplier quality and delivery issues through Critical Action Plans; manage Approved Vendor List (AVL) qualification and supplier performance.
- Lead new product introduction (NPI), product supersession, and lifecycle decisions for private-label parts, using lifecycle analytics to decide SKU introduction, continuation, and end-of-life; coordinate spare parts, refurbishment, and warranty returns.
- Identified gaps that became new internal products: an ML-based forecasting program, a new product tool, and dynamic min-max inventory logic, each taken from idea through design, build, and adoption.
- Apply statistical and ML forecasting to demand and supply planning, using retail channel data such as EDI and POS to improve availability and inventory decisions.
- Ran A/B tests on promotions, price elasticity, and new product launch strategies for private-label brands.
- Own the roadmap for a catalog management portal used by 30,000+ customers and 120+ suppliers, writing PRDs and working with engineers through release and UAT; reached a 92% data completeness score, with brands recognized at SEMA Gold level for data quality.
- Bridge senior leaders (VP Category Management, VP IT, SVP, CFO, CEO) and technical teams, turning business needs into requirements for analytics tools and AI agents; brief them on supplier performance, cost, and supply risk using Tableau and Power BI dashboards across 15 private-label brands.

- Lead 4 direct and 3 indirect reports with a formal intake, prioritization, and delivery governance process.

Inventory Process Specialist — Supply Chain Optimization — LKQ Corporation **Oct 2021 – Mar 2023**
Bengaluru, India

- Built a Python- and SQL-driven forecasting engine across 6,000+ SKUs using statistical and ML-based methods, lifting rolling 52-week forecast accuracy from 53% to 74%.
- Built a scenario simulation platform to model supply and demand risk and bottlenecks in real time, giving leadership early visibility before issues reached operations.
- Led a Tableau BI transformation that automated manual reporting, cutting turnaround time by 70% and raising adoption across 20+ FTEs.
- Led and developed 4 direct and 3 indirect reports (Business Analysts), owning dashboards, MIS reporting, and SQL data warehousing.

Senior Consultant — Supply Chain Analytics & Transformation — Bristlecone Ltd. **Jun 2019 – Sep 2021**
Bengaluru, India

- Led a 5-member cross-functional team to build Rapid Insights 360, a supply chain analytics product, taking it from prototype through introduction to commercial offerings on the SAP App Center, and laying the foundation for a new Analytics & AI Practice Center of Excellence.
- Architected the product on a data warehouse layer so it ran on SAP and Oracle ERP and stayed compatible with other ERP and data systems; separated reusable core capabilities from client-specific configuration.
- Built reusable accelerators, frameworks, and dashboards in Power BI, Tableau, Qlik Sense, Sisense, and SAP SAC, used by pre-sales teams, deployed on the SAP App Center, and shared with customers.
- Ran pre-sales and product demonstrations for 18–20 prospects across CPG, semiconductor, healthcare, financial services, and energy; tracked the pipeline in Salesforce.
- Presented to CPOs, CTOs, SVPs, and VPs at Fortune 500 accounts and led 3+ end-to-end engagements ($500K–$2M in deal value) from proposals through delivery and hypercare.
- Built ML forecasting models with PyCaret; advised on SAP IBP, Kinaxis, and SAP procurement implementations and supported a material and BoM readiness engagement for an enterprise hardware client.

Front Lead Engineer — Ultratech Cements — Aditya Birla Group **Sep 2015 – Apr 2018**
Multiple Locations, India

- Built SAP-based MIS dashboards that helped reduce working capital in slow-moving assets by 28%; led a Lean Six Sigma DMAIC project saving INR 1.5 Cr annually and cutting energy use by 1.3 kWh/ton.

Software Engineer — Tech Mahindra **Jun 2014 – Sep 2015**
Pune, India

- Owned end-to-end delivery of a reporting dashboard for a US telecom client, from development through client-facing support.

EDUCATION

Great Lakes Institute of Management, Chennai, India — Post Graduate Program (MBA), Marketing
Government College of Engineering, Chandrapur (R.T.M. Nagpur University), India — Bachelor of Engineering, Electrical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt; Certified Supply Chain Professional (CSCP) — in progress
- “Best Kaizen” award (twice) and “Most Valuable Member” award, LKQ Corporation
- “Beautiful Mind” and “Core Values in Action” awards, Bristlecone